

Investor profile

NAME: Charlie

AGE: 25

JOB: Junior doctor

1. What does your investment portfolio look like?

I have a 20 per cent Simplicity growth fund; 30 per cent Simplicity balanced fund; 15 per cent Vanguard index fund; 5 per cent NZX 50; 20 per cent Mercury Energy shares (this was a gift from a family member many years ago); 10 per cent USA shares (even split between NVIDIA, Apple, Tesla); less than 1 per cent crypto.

2. When did you begin investing and what was your first investment?

In 2020 with \$2000 in the Vanguard International Shares Index Fund on InvestNow.

I spent many months researching and educating myself (mostly through the subreddit /PersonalFinanceNZ, and the *Friends That Invest* podcast, of course) and finally decided on this particular index fund.

I'm a hypochondriac but also super indecisive, which wasn't a good combination as I kept delaying making my first investment. I finally realised the best investing style for myself would be 'set and forget', so now I just make regular auto-investments into a couple of index funds/ETFs that resonate with my investing principles.

3. What stopped you from investing; were there any barriers you had to overcome?

Lack of knowledge and unsure where or how to start the journey, stigma from immigrant parents who had a negative view that investing was centred around a 'volatile stock market', which